

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Canon ImageClass MP390 All-in-one

The Canon ImageClass MP390 caters to both the home user as well as the SoHo segment, with PictBridge USB connectivity to directly connect your digital camera to the printer and take photo printouts.



Its slow print speed means this MFD is not for bulk printing.

The functions on the control panel on top of the unit are clearly explained on the small LCD screen, and you can start using the MFD in no time. Installation of the device is easy, and both Twain and WIA drivers are provided for the scanner—to be used when using a graphics application for scanning.

The built-in fax unit makes the MP390 suitable for a SoHo environment and the

software bundle is extensive too. The MFD has a multi-purpose paper feed tray that holds about 100 sheets.

The rated printing speed is 18 ppm in fast mode, and 12 ppm in normal mode. However, in our tests, the Canon MP390 was slower than that. Though the image quality was good, it is by no means the best we've seen. Scanning an image at full colour at a resolution of 600 dpi took one minute and 11 seconds. This is quite fast, considering that

the quality of the image scanned was distinctly above average.

The Canon MP390 comes with a two-year warranty. Printing and scanning apart, this MFD loses points as it doesn't bundle in an automatic document feeder.

SPECIFICATIONS

Print, copy, scan and fax features; PictBridge technology; memory card slot; USB port for connecting digital cameras

Canon ImageClass MP390		B-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 23,990
Contact: SES TECH limited
Phone: 022-26824141
E-mail: kp@sesindia.com
Web site: www.intel.com

Iomega REV Removable Hard Disk Drive

The REV external solution from Iomega will find favour with corporate and SoHo users; the product is



essentially an alternative for tape backup. It will not appeal to regular computer users who do not consider data backup a priority—a CD or DVD writer would do just fine.

The drive has a capacity of 35 GB in uncompressed format, and 70 GB in compressed format.

We reviewed the external USB 2.0 version—an internal parallel ATA version is also available. Drive connectivity is simple—all you need to do is connect the drive to USB 2.0 port on your computer. Just connecting the drive to the computer will enable read access; for writing to the disk, you'll need to install the drivers.

You can control access to the drive by either granting read-only access, or by

locking the drive altogether. You can also password-protect the cartridge, which will take care of any

unauthorised attempts to accessing data from the disk. The software bundle is good and includes a REV version of Norton Ghost.

The sequential read speed for this drive was 22 MBps in our tests, while

random read speed was 3.9 MBps with an average access time of 107 ms. We performed real world tests that included the reading and writing of a 1 GB file to and from the drive. Reading and writing of the file both took the same time—46 seconds—which is comparable to the performance of any good 7200 rpm external hard drive.

A drawback with this drive is that it is not forward compatible, which means that if you insert a 70GB cartridge—when it becomes available—it will still only be read as a 35 GB cartridge.

SPECIFICATIONS

35 GB native capacity per removable disk; transfer rates of 12.7 to 25.4 MBps; approx. 5 years drive service life; USB 2.0 or ATAPI interface

Price: Rs.23,850 (USB 2.0)/Rs.22,500 (ATAPI)
Contact: Neoteric
Phone: 022-24172600
E-mail: sales@neoteric-info.com
Web site: www.iomega.com

Iomega REV		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	